



HELIOS AND PHAËTHON

Helios rode his chariot across the sky each day, pulling the burning sun behind him.

Now, Helios had a young son named Phaëthon, but Phaëthon refused to believe that he was the son of a god. One day he demanded of Helios: "If you really are my father, then let me drive your chariot today."

Helios doubted that Phaëthon would be able to command the willful horses, but he could not say no to his son. He placed the boy in the chariot and handed him the reins. Sure enough, Phaëthon quickly lost control and began to careen across the sky, threatening to burn the Earth.

Zeus, who was watching from Mount Olympus, knew he had to act to save the world. He threw one of his thunderbolts and struck the boy, stopping the chariot, but killing Phaëthon.



SELENE SAVES OLYMPUS

Each night, as Helios returned to Olympus, Selene set out in her shining silver chariot to break up the darkness with the light of the moon.

Typhoeus was a monstrous giant. Hundreds of snakes grew from his shoulders and he flew with a huge pair of wings. He had decided to challenge Zeus for his throne, and one night he charged on Mount Olympus. Selene loved Zeus, so when the king of the gods was threatened, she rushed to his aid.

Selene saw Typhoeus and stood guard at the gates. He hurled ferocious bulls at Selene, but she did not back down. She batted away each bull and was able to beat Typhoeus back. From that day on, the white surface of the moon was scarred by dark spots, where she had been hit.